

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET B — ADVANCED HOTS & ANALYTICAL THINKING****CHAPTER 05: STATE AND SOCIETY UP TO 1000 CE**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-B-05

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET B - Advanced HOTS & Analytical Thinking):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Higher Order Thinking Skills (HOTS) Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed to test **deep causal reasoning, critical source evaluation, constitutional mechanics, and economic analysis**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **ADVANCED HOTS INSTRUCTIONS:** Carefully analyze the socio-historical contexts, geomorphic cause-and-effect relationships, and constitutional principles before selecting your answer.

Q.1 Why did the middle Gangetic plain witness the emergence of powerful centralized territorial kingdoms (Mahajanapadas) by the 6th century BCE?

- (A) Widespread adoption of iron axes to clear dense monsoon forests, iron ploughshares creating agrarian surpluses, and control over riverine trade networks
- (B) The arrival of modern steam engines and electrical telecommunications
- (C) The total abandonment of agriculture in favor of pastoral wandering
- (D) An extreme ice age that forced all humans into stone caves

Q.2 How did the political structure of the Vajji 'Gana-Sangha' (republic) differ fundamentally from the monarchy of Magadha?

- (A) In Vajji, sovereign authority was exercised collectively by an assembly of clan chiefs (Rajas) through debate and consensus, whereas Magadha was ruled by an absolute hereditary monarch
- (B) Vajji was ruled by foreign Greek satraps, while Magadha had no ruler
- (C) Vajji had no laws and was ruled by animals
- (D) Magadha held democratic popular referendums every month to choose its prime minister

Q.3 In Kautilya's *Arthashastra*, what is the 'Saptanga' theory of the state?

- (A) The organic conception of the state as comprising seven interrelated constituent elements: Swami (King), Amatya (Ministers), Janapada (Territory/People), Durga (Fort), Kosha (Treasury), Danda (Army), and Mitra (Ally)
- (B) The division of society into seven musical notes
- (C) A military plan to conquer seven foreign continents across the Pacific Ocean
- (D) A dietary prescription requiring seven types of grains

Q.4 Why did Emperor Ashoka promote 'Dhamma' as an overarching state ideology rather than imposing sectarian Buddhist theological doctrines on his subjects?

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| (A) Dhamma was an inclusive, universal ethical code (tolerance, non-violence, filial respect, and inter-faith harmony) designed to integrate an empire of diverse ethnic, linguistic, and religious communities | (B) Ashoka was legally forced by foreign kings to abandon all religion |
| (C) Dhamma was a military strategy to conquer China and Japan | (D) Ashoka wanted to ban all languages except Greek across India |

Q.5 In Major Rock Edict XII, what fundamental principle of religious governance does Emperor Ashoka articulate?

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| (A) Restraint in praising one's own religious sect and disparaging other sects, recognizing that honoring other faiths strengthens one's own faith | (B) Execution of anyone who refuses to convert to Buddhism |
| (C) Confiscation of all wealth belonging to religious shrines | (D) A ban on speaking any language other than Prakrit in temples |

Q.6 How did the geographical location of Magadha's two capitals, Rajagriha and Pataliputra, provide exceptional strategic military advantages?

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| (A) Rajagriha was fortified by a ring of five natural rocky hills (Girivraja); Pataliputra sat at the confluence of major navigable rivers (Ganga, Son, Gandak, Ghaghara), functioning as a water fortress (Jaladurga) | (B) Both capitals were built on floating wooden barges in the Indian Ocean |
| (C) Both cities were buried 500 meters beneath underground caves | (D) The capitals were located in snow-capped Arctic glaciers |

Q.7 What significant diplomatic and cultural consequence followed the peace treaty between Chandragupta Maurya and the Hellenistic Seleucid emperor Seleucus I Nicator around 303 BCE?

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| (A) The Mauryan Empire secured the northwestern territories (Arachosia, Gedrosia, Paropamisadae), an alliance, and received Greek ambassador Megasthenes at Pataliputra | (B) Seleucus conquered Pataliputra and forced all Mauryan citizens into exile |
| (C) The Mauryans ceded all of northern India to the Greek kingdom of Macedonia | (D) Chandragupta Maurya converted to ancient Greek Olympian paganism |

Q.8 Why did the Gupta Empire issue large volumes of high-purity gold coins (Dinaras) while copper coins from the Gupta period are relatively scarce in the archaeological record?

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| (A) Gold coins served high-value state transactions, foreign long-distance commerce, and royal land donations, while daily village markets relied increasingly on barter and cowrie shells | (B) Gupta kings had zero knowledge of how to melt copper |
| (C) Copper was considered spiritually impure under Hindu law | (D) Gold was cheaper and more abundant than clay in ancient India |

Q.9 In the Allahabad Pillar Inscription (Prayag Prashasti), how does court poet Harishena describe Samudragupta's contrasting imperial policies toward the kings of Aryavarta versus the kings of Dakshinapatha (South India)?

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| (A) Aryavarta rulers were violently uprooted and their kingdoms directly annexed (*prasabhoddharana*); Dakshinapatha rulers were defeated, released, and reinstated as tributary vassals (*grahana-moksha-anugraha*) | (B) Southern kings were executed, while northern kings were given golden crowns |
| (C) Both northern and southern kings were forced to build ships and sail to Rome | (D) Samudragupta refused to fight any wars and gave his kingdom away |

Q.10 What transformative scientific breakthrough did the astronomer-mathematician Aryabhata propose in his 499 CE treatise *Aryabhatiya*?

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| (A) He asserted that the Earth is spherical, rotates daily on its own axis, and correctly attributed solar and lunar eclipses to planetary and lunar shadows rather than mythological demons | (B) He invented the modern electronic digital computer |
| (C) He claimed the Earth was flat and rested on the back of giant elephants | (D) He proved that the sun orbits around the Indian subcontinent |

Q.11 How did the practice of royal land grants (*Agrahara* and *Brahmadeya*) to temples and Brahmins under the Guptas and subsequent dynasties transform early medieval agrarian society?

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| (A) It decentralized administrative authority, introduced intermediary landed feudal elites between the monarch and peasants, and extended cultivation into peripheral tribal frontiers | (B) It abolished all farming and turned India into an industrial factory state |
| (C) It caused all agricultural land to be confiscated by foreign merchants | (D) It made all villagers identical royal kings |

Q.12 What unique democratic mechanism was recorded in the 10th-century CE Uttaramerur inscription of Chola King Parantaka I for selecting village committee members?

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| (A) The *Kudavolai* system: names of eligible property-owning, educated candidates were written on palm-leaf tickets, placed in an earthen pot, and drawn by a young boy | (B) The village king appointed his eldest son to every single committee |
| (C) Committee seats were auctioned off to the highest wealthy bidder | (D) Members fought in physical sword duels to win committee seats |

Q.13 Under the Chola local administrative system, what was the structural difference between the 'Ur' and the 'Sabha' (or Mahasabha)?

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| (A) The 'Ur' was the general village assembly of non-Brahmin tax-paying landholders; the 'Sabha' was the autonomous assembly of learned Brahmins in *Brahmadeya* tax-exempt villages | (B) The 'Ur' was a military council of cavalry officers; the 'Sabha' was an assembly of Buddhist monks |
| (C) The 'Ur' met only at midnight; the 'Sabha' met only during monsoons | (D) There was no difference; both were names for royal tax collectors |

Q.14 Why is the monolithic Kailash Temple (Cave 16) at Ellora considered one of the most astonishing architectural achievements in world history?

- (A) It was carved top-down out of a single solid basalt cliff face, with over 200,000 tonnes of rock excavated without assembling detached masonry blocks, under Rashtrakuta King Krishna I
- (B) It was constructed using prefabricated cement imported from modern Rome
- (C) It was built in one single hour using automated steam cranes
- (D) It was carved out of soft white candle wax

Q.15 What does the flourishing of ancient South Indian maritime trade guilds like the *Manigramam* and *Ayyavole 500* (Ainnurruvar) demonstrate about the Indian Ocean economy up to 1000 CE?

- (A) Powerful, self-regulating corporate merchant guilds operated armed merchant vessels, secured royal trade charters, and maintained commercial colonies across Southeast Asia and China
- (B) Ancient Indian merchants were legally prohibited from traveling on ocean ships
- (C) South Indian merchants only traded within their own immediate home village
- (D) Trade was conducted entirely by foreign European colonizers

Q.16 How does Megasthenes's division of Indian society into seven classes in his *Indica* reflect the lens of a foreign observer interpreting Indian social realities?

- (A) He conflated occupational and administrative divisions (philosophers, farmers, soldiers, herdsman, artisans, magistrates, councillors) with the traditional four-fold *Varna* framework
- (B) He accurately recorded that India had no social classes or differences whatsoever
- (C) He translated Egyptian royal court decrees into Sanskrit
- (D) He copied the social system of the Roman Senate directly into his book

Q.17 What military and economic impact did the Chola maritime naval expeditions to Sri Vijaya (modern Sumatra and the Malayan peninsula) under Rajendra Chola I around 1025 CE have?

- (A) They broke Sri Vijaya's trade monopoly over the Strait of Malacca, securing unhindered sea lanes for Tamil merchant guilds trading with Song-dynasty China
- (B) They colonized China and made it a province of the Chola Empire
- (C) They resulted in the total destruction of all South Indian temples
- (D) They led to the permanent closure of all maritime trade across the Indian Ocean

Q.18 In ancient Indian historical epigraphy, what is the significance of the Junagadh rock inscription of Saka ruler Rudradaman I (c. 150 CE)?

- (A) It records the history of the artificial Sudarshana Lake reservoir, built under Chandragupta Maurya and repaired under Rudradaman, written in sophisticated classical chaste Sanskrit
- (B) It is the oldest surviving printed English novel in Asia
- (C) It proves that the Saka rulers destroyed all water canals in western India
- (D) It records the construction of the Great Wall of China

Q.19 Why was the Nalanda Mahavihara considered an intellectual epicenter of the ancient world that attracted thousands of scholars like Hiuen Tsang and I-Tsang?

- (A) It offered rigorous residential higher education in Buddhist philosophy, logic (*Hetuvidya*), Sanskrit grammar, medicine, and astronomy, supported by royal revenues from over 100 villages
- (B) It was a military training camp for foreign cavalry archers
- (C) Students were admitted without any academic examination or interview
- (D) It was located on a floating glacier in the Arctic Ocean

Q.20 How does the play *Mudrarakshasa* by Vishakhadatta dramatize the political founding of the Mauryan Empire?

- (A) It focuses on the intense psychological and Machiavellian political intrigue between Chanakya and Rakshasa (the loyal Nanda minister) to secure Chandragupta's dynastic legitimacy
- (B) It depicts a magical war fought with mythological flying chariots
- (C) It records the life of ordinary Greek fishermen living in Athens
- (D) It is a musical comedy about farming wheat in Punjab

Q.21 Which South Indian architectural style is characterized by colossal pyramidal gate towers called 'Gopurams', pillared mandapas, and water tanks within massive temple enclosures?

- (A) Dravidian architectural style
- (B) Nagara architectural style
- (C) Vesara architectural style
- (D) Gothic architectural style

Q.22 What socio-economic transformation distinguished the Later Vedic period (c. 1000–600 BCE) from the Early Rigvedic pastoral society?

- (A) Sedentary agrarian lifestyle with iron tools, rigid four-fold hereditary *Varna* hierarchy, complex sacrificial rituals (*Ashvamedha*), and emergence of territorial chiefdoms (*Janapadas*)
- (B) Total transition to nomadic horse hunting in Central Asia
- (C) Abolition of all religious rituals and kingship in favor of pure communism
- (D) The mass production of plastic tools and synthetic fabrics

Q.23 How did the Chinese pilgrim Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang) describe law and order, administration, and public welfare during King Harshavardhana's reign in the 7th century CE?

- (A) He praised Harsha's personal piety, patronization of Buddhism, and charitable dispensaries, but noted that highway travel was perilous with frequent robberies compared to Gupta times
- (B) He stated that Harsha ruled an empire of stone statues without human beings
- (C) He recorded that India had no rivers, mountains, or trees
- (D) He claimed that all citizens spoke modern French

Q.24 What was the administrative and economic role of ancient Indian merchant guilds (*Shrenis*) in urban commercial life?

- (A) They set product quality standards, fixed wage rates, trained apprentices, functioned as banks accepting interest-bearing public deposits, and funded civic temples
- (B) They were criminal outlaw bands that attacked passing merchant ships
- (C) They were religious monasteries where no commercial goods were sold
- (D) They were royal military infantry units tasked with fighting wars

Q.25 Why does the Iron Pillar at Mehrauli, Delhi, remain a metallurgical wonder of the ancient world after 1,600 years?

- (A) Its high-phosphorus wrought iron composition and passive protective surface film of iron hydrogen phosphate hydrate (*misawite*) prevent atmospheric oxidation and rusting
- (B) It is coated with a modern synthetic plastic paint layer
- (C) It was manufactured in space and dropped by an alien spacecraft
- (D) It is kept in a climate-controlled vacuum glass box by the government

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET B)

01	(A) (B) (C) (D)	02	(A) (B) (C) (D)	03	(A) (B) (C) (D)	04	(A) (B) (C) (D)	05	(A) (B) (C) (D)
06	(A) (B) (C) (D)	07	(A) (B) (C) (D)	08	(A) (B) (C) (D)	09	(A) (B) (C) (D)	10	(A) (B) (C) (D)
11	(A) (B) (C) (D)	12	(A) (B) (C) (D)	13	(A) (B) (C) (D)	14	(A) (B) (C) (D)	15	(A) (B) (C) (D)
16	(A) (B) (C) (D)	17	(A) (B) (C) (D)	18	(A) (B) (C) (D)	19	(A) (B) (C) (D)	20	(A) (B) (C) (D)
21	(A) (B) (C) (D)	22	(A) (B) (C) (D)	23	(A) (B) (C) (D)	24	(A) (B) (C) (D)	25	(A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET B)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Analytical Rationale
Q.1	(A)	Iron metallurgy (clearing hardwood sal forests, deep tilling with iron ploughs) generated agricultural surpluses that sustained standing armies, urban craft centers, and state revenue.
Q.2	(A)	Gana-Sanghas like Vajji and the Shakyas were aristocratic republics where power resided in a corporate assembly of Kshatriya clan elders, distinct from Magadhan autocratic kingship.
Q.3	(A)	Kautilya's Saptanga theory views the state as an organic body with seven interdependent organs, where the king is the head, ministers are eyes, and the treasury is the mouth.
Q.4	(A)	Ashoka's Dhamma transcended sectarian dogmas, functioning as a civic-moral glue to unite a vast multi-cultural empire and resolve social tensions between Brahmins, Shramanas, and diverse sects.
Q.5	(A)	Rock Edict XII is a foundational declaration of religious pluralism and mutual respect, warning that sectarian chauvinism harms the essence (*saravridhi*) of all religious traditions.
Q.6	(A)	Rajagriha's pentagonal hill barriers made it impregnable to sieges, while Pataliputra's riverine convergence enabled swift troop movements, naval logistics, and river toll collections.
Q.7	(A)	The treaty established formal diplomatic parity, transferred modern eastern Afghanistan and Balochistan to the Mauryas in exchange for 500 war elephants, and initiated Greek envoys.
Q.8	(A)	High-value gold dinaras financed state prestige, external trade, and merchant guilds, while the scarcity of base-metal copper coins indicates localized demonetization and cowrie shell usage.
Q.9	(A)	Recognizing logistical limits in controlling distant southern kingdoms from Pataliputra, Samudragupta annexed nearby Gangetic kings directly but restored southern rulers as tributary feudatories.
Q.10	(A)	Aryabhata pioneered rational heliometric mathematics: earth's diurnal axial rotation, calculating $\pi \approx 3.1416$, and explaining eclipses as geometric shadows (*Chhaya*).
Q.11	(A)	Land grants alienated fiscal and judicial rights to donees, creating localized landlord intermediaries, agrarian expansion into tribal hinterlands, and an early medieval feudal hierarchy.
Q.12	(A)	Chola local self-governance utilized the *Kudavolai* lottery: qualified elders (possessing land, Vedic education, clean accounts) were chosen via randomized palm-leaf drawings from pots.
Q.13	(A)	The *Ur* functioned in peasant agricultural villages (*Vellanvagai*), while the *Sabha* governed elite *Brahmadeya* villages through specialized sub-committees (*Variyams*).
Q.14	(A)	Commissioned by Rashtrakuta monarch Krishna I (c. 756–774 CE), the Kailash temple is a monolithic marvel carved vertically downward from the living cliff with intricate multi-tiered Dravidian vimana.
Q.15	(A)	Chola-era guilds (*Ayyavole*, *Manigramam*) financed trans-oceanic shipping, maintained private security guards, and operated permanent trading settlements in Sumatra, Java, and southern China.
Q.16	(A)	Megasthenes observed real occupational functional groups in imperial Pataliputra, mapping them onto a 7-class schema familiar to Hellenistic Greeks rather than the scriptural four Varnas.
Q.17	(A)	Rajendra Chola's naval campaign secured crucial maritime choke points (Strait of Malacca, Sunda Strait) to defend Chola mercantile profits in the Sino-Indian maritime trade network.
Q.18	(A)	Rudradaman's Junagadh inscription is a milestone: the earliest lengthy public Sanskrit epigraph, recording centuries of public hydraulic engineering at Sudarshana Lake without taxing subjects.
Q.19	(A)	Nalanda's gatekeeper (*Dwarapandita*) conducted fierce entrance examinations; admitted students debated advanced epistemology (*Nyaya*), Mahayana metaphysics, and secular sciences.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Analytical Rationale
Q.20	(A)	Vishakhadatta's political drama depicts Chanakya's ruthless realpolitik diplomacy, espionage, and reconciliation with the loyal minister Rakshasa to stabilize Chandragupta's state.
Q.21	(A)	The Dravidian architectural idiom, perfected under the Pallavas, Cholas, and Pandyas, features tall storied Vimanas, pillared halls (*Mandapas*), and towering gateway *Gopurams*.
Q.22	(A)	Later Vedic society shifted from pastoral semi-nomadism to settled farming, rigidified the Varna-Jati order, expanded sacrificial Brahmanical hegemony, and crystallized territorial states.
Q.23	(A)	Xuanzang noted Harsha's energetic travels, patronization of the Kanauj assembly, and charitable *Punya-shalas*, but reported being robbed multiple times, indicating localized feudal decay.
Q.24	(A)	Shrenis operated with judicial autonomy under guild chiefs (*Jetthakas*), regulated production, minted tokens, issued commercial loans, and acted as public charitable trustees.
Q.25	(A)	Advanced Gupta metallurgy forged pure wrought iron with high phosphorus slag inclusions, creating an adherent passive protective film that withstands weathering without rusting.